M4010104 / M4020104: PROGRAMMING IN PYTHON · DIGITAL UNIVERSITY KERALA · CAPSTONE PROJECT SPECIFICATION

Project 13: 13-Year All-India Air Quality Trend & 2020 Lockdown Anomaly Quantifier

Effort Budget: 10–12 Hours | Core Stack: Pure Python, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly | Max Marks: 25 | Instructor: Dr. Sunil TT

1. Executive Overview & Domain Context

Spanning over a decade (2010–2023) across monitoring stations in hundreds of Indian cities, this longitudinal dataset documents long-term industrial pollution trajectories alongside the unprecedented natural experiment of the 2020 COVID-19 mobility lockdowns. Decadal environmental records allow researchers to decouple structural industrial emissions from baseline vehicular pollution.

Your team will develop a rigorous policy analytics pipeline in Python that filters stations with complete decadal records, quantifies the statistically significant percentage drop in NO2 and PM2.5 during the April–May 2020 lockdown relative to the 2017–2019 pre-lockdown baseline in NumPy, and measures the 2021–2023 rebound trajectory answering the 12 core questions below.

Primary Public Dataset & Telemetry/Data Schema

The project utilizes the verified public Time-Series Air Quality Data of India (2010–2023) on Kaggle (**`https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/abhisheksjha/time-series-air-quality-data-of-india-2010-2023`**). The dataset structure captures:

- **Raw Feature Attributes:** **`station_id`**, **`city`**, **`state`**, **`date`**, **`pm25`**, **`pm10`**, **`no2`**, **`co`**, **`so2`**, **`o3`**.
- **Engineered / Target Variables:** **`lockdown_phase`** (Pre-Lockdown, Lockdown-2020, Rebound), **`delta_pm25_pct`**, **`delta_no2_pct`**, **`rebound_rate`**.

2. Complete Project Directory & File Architecture

Each team must organize their repository into a standardized, production-grade layout. All application source code must reside inside a dedicated package (**`src/`**), with separate directories for raw/curated data, interactive development notebooks, visual figures, and formal documentation:

```
india-air-quality-lockdown-study/
├── README.md                          # Repository documentation & GitHub Pages source
├── requirements.txt                   # Dependency specification (numpy, pandas, matplotlib, seaborn, p
├── run_pipeline.py                    # Standalone production CLI application entry point
├── data/
│   ├── raw/
│   │   └── india_air_quality_13yr_raw.csv            # Raw uncleaned input dataset (including simulated
│   └── processed/
│       ├── clean_india_air_13yr.csv          # Curated, validated clean CSV dataset
│       └── lockdown_air_audit.log           # Timestamped audit report detailing filtered/rejected reco
├── src/
│   ├── __init__.py                    # Python package initialization
│   ├── ingestion.py                   # Defensive line-by-line file reader, range auditor & CSV exporte
│   ├── analyzer.py                    # LockdownImpactAuditor OOP class, NumPy vectorization & Pandas a
│   └── visualizer.py                  # Matplotlib envelope plots, Seaborn heatmaps & Plotly HTML expor
├── notebooks/
│   └── development_cycle.ipynb        # Development cycle notebook: EDA, trials, tests & unit assertion
└── reports/
    ├── figures/
    │   ├── primary_envelope.png       # Matplotlib confidence envelope & regression overlay
    │   ├── correlation_heatmap.png    # Seaborn annotated feature correlation heatmap
    │   └── distribution_regimes.png   # Seaborn distribution across categorical/domain tiers
```

```
    ├── interactive_dashboard.html     # Standalone interactive Plotly HTML dashboard with controls
    └── Project_Report.pdf             # 3-4 page final technical report
```

3. Dual Development Deliverables: Notebook vs. Standalone Program

To mirror industry software engineering standards, each student group must deliver two distinct, complementary implementations of their solution:

Deliverable A: The Development Cycle Notebook (`notebooks/development_cycle.ipynb`)

The development notebook chronicles your team's engineering journey from raw data exploration to validated model prototypes. It is not merely a final script pasted into cells, but an authentic record of the development cycle:

- **Phase 1: Exploratory Data Ingestion & Diagnostics:** Loading raw data, inspecting missing values, testing boundary rules, and logging rejected records.
- **Phase 2: Mathematical Formulation & Feature Verification:** Developing and validating NumPy array calculations against target benchmarks using `np.allclose()`.
- **Phase 3: OOP Class Architecture & Unit Tests:** Instantiating the `LockdownImpactAuditor` class, executing automated unit assertions (e.g., verifying that passing invalid parameters raises an explicit `ValueError`), and testing edge cases.
- **Phase 4: Statistical Modeling & Regimen Exploration:** Implementing ordinary least-squares regression, rolling-window calculations, and multi-metric Pandas grouping.
- **Phase 5: Visual Prototype Development:** Iteratively designing and refining Matplotlib and Seaborn figures, followed by configuring the interactive Plotly HTML dashboard.

Deliverable B: The Final Standalone Python Program (`run_pipeline.py` & `src/`)

While the notebook documents the exploratory development cycle, your repository must also provide a production-ready, fully executable Python application. The program must run end-to-end directly from the terminal without requiring Jupyter:

- **Command-Line Interface (CLI):** Executed via `python run_pipeline.py --input data/raw/india_air_quality_13yr_raw.csv --output-dir data/processed --report-dir reports`.
- **Modular Package Import:** The driver script imports cleanly separated domain logic from `src.ingestion`, `src.analyzer`, and `src.visualizer`.
- **Terminal Feedback & Exit Codes:** The program must print structured progress indicators, log clean/faulty record counts to the console, and return an exit code of `0` upon successful pipeline completion.
- **Automated Artifact Generation:** In a single execution pass, the script reads raw inputs, writes `data/processed/clean_india_air_13yr.csv`, saves `data/processed/lockdown_air_audit.log`, exports static figures to `reports/figures/`, and generates the standalone `reports/interactive_dashboard.html`.

4. Technical Investigation Requirements & Research Questions (Q1–Q12)

Your team's implementation across the development notebook and standalone program must rigorously answer the following 12 course-aligned engineering questions:

Course Topic & Script	Q#	Concrete Engineering & Analytical Task	Python Libraries & Methods
File I/O & Exceptions (`src/ingestion.py`)	Q1	**Station Coverage & Decadal Boundary Audit:** Parse 13-year daily station rows using try-except. Validate date formats, verify date bounds [2010, 2023], and reject negative pollutant readings into an audit log.	open(), try-except (ValueError, IndexError), date parsing

Course Topic & Script	Q#	Concrete Engineering & Analytical Task	Python Libraries & Methods
Data Curation & Export (`src/ingestion.py`)	**Q2**	**Curated Decadal Air Quality Export & Audit:** Export sanitized station records to clean_india_air_13yr.csv. Concurrently log stations with < 70% temporal completeness into lockdown_air_audit.log.	Defensive file writing, dictionary parsing, formatted log reporting
OOP Design (`src/ingestion.py`)	**Q3**	**Lockdown Impact Auditor Class:** Design an encapsulated class LockdownImpactAuditor with methods load_from_csv(), compute_lockdown_delta(baseline_years=[2017, 2018, 2019]), and summary_report(). Ensure empty baseline raises ValueError.	OOP class, __init__, encapsulation, raise ValueError
NumPy Arrays (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q4**	**Vectorized Baseline Departures & Verification:** Using only raw NumPy arrays, compute mean pre-lockdown baseline concentrations (April-May 2017-2019) and calculate the percentage departure during April-May 2020. Verify via np.allclose().	np.mean(), np.divide(), np.allclose()
NumPy Masking (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q5**	**Steepest Drop vs. Rapid Rebound City Masking:** Flag cities recording > 40% drops in NO2 during lockdown in NumPy. Compare against cities showing rapid rebound (> 30% increase) in 2021-2022 using boolean masks.	np.mean(), np.std(), boolean masks (&, |), Python set
NumPy Regression (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q6**	**Mobility Reduction vs. NO2 Drop OLS Model:** Fit an ordinary least-squares model relating NO2 percentage reduction to city population density and industrial station count via np.linalg.lstsq. Quantify regression R2.	np.column_stack(), np.linalg.lstsq(), matrix product (@), R2
Pandas Series (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q7**	**City Station Completeness & Missing Data Audit:** Quantify active monitoring days per city across the 13-year window in Pandas. Identify tier-1 vs. tier-2 cities with continuous temporal coverage.	.groupby('city').count(), .isna().sum()
Pandas Groupby (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q8**	**City-by-Period Discretization & Pivot Table:** Assign dates to 3 periods: Pre-Lockdown (2017-2019), Lockdown (2020), and Post-Lockdown (2021-2023). Build a City-by-Period pivot_table(margins=True) showing mean PM2.5 and NO2.	pd.cut(), .groupby().agg(), .pivot_table(margins=True)
Pandas Reshaping (`src/analyzer.py`)	**Q9**	**Wide-to-Long Pollutant Trajectory Ranking via Melt:** Reshape annual median concentrations for PM2.5, PM10, and NO2 into long format via pd.melt() and extract top 5 cities with the highest decadal reduction.	pd.melt(), .groupby(['city', 'pollutant']), .nlargest(5)
Matplotlib (`src/visualizer.py`)	**Q10**	**Matplotlib 13-Year Longitudinal Trend Plot:** Plot 13-year monthly PM2.5 and NO2 trajectories for top metropolitan centers in Matplotlib. Shade the 2020 lockdown window in yellow with annotated percentage drops.	plt.subplots(), ax.plot(), ax.axvspan(), custom legends
Seaborn (`src/visualizer.py`)	**Q11**	**Seaborn Pre-vs-Post Lockdown Boxplots & Heatmap:** Render side-by-side Seaborn boxplots comparing PM2.5 and NO2 across Pre-Lockdown, Lockdown, and Post-Lockdown phases. Generate a state-by-year median NO2 heatmap.	sns.boxplot(), sns.heatmap(), sns.despine()
Plotly HTML (`src/visualizer.py`)	**Q12**	**Interactive Decadal Air Quality Explorer:** Build an interactive HTML dashboard (interactive_dashboard.html) displaying 13-year pollution trends with city search filters, lockdown comparison overlays, and time sliders.	plotly.express.line(), custom hover tooltips, write_html()

5. Collaborative Git Workflow, GitHub Pages & README.md Specification

Best Practices: Collaborative Git Workflow & GitHub Pages Deployment from Day 1

From the very first day, the student team must adopt professional version control and documentation practices. On Day 1, one designated team member initializes the central public GitHub repository, establishes a clear branch protection rule preventing direct pushes to **`main`**, adds all teammates as registered **Contributors** (with write access), and grants read access to the Course Instructor (**`Dr. Sunil TT`**) and teaching assistants. Immediately thereafter, the team must activate **GitHub Pages** (via *Settings → Pages → Build and deployment: Deploy from a branch: main /docs or root*) so that project documentation, interactive architecture diagrams, and the live Plotly dashboard (**`reports/interactive_dashboard.html`**) are publicly accessible and continuously deployed throughout the development lifecycle. All feature development must follow a strict branching model (e.g., **`feature/ingestion`**, **`feature/analysis`**, **`feature/visualization`**): individual team members must write small, atomic, well-commented commits from their own personal GitHub accounts and merge them into **`main`** exclusively through formal **Pull Requests (PRs)** accompanied by peer review. Dumping entire codebases in a single, monolithic end-of-semester commit is strictly prohibited and will result in zero marks for individual Git contribution; maintaining an unbroken, transparent Git commit and PR audit trail is essential for passing the code ownership defense during the live viva-voce examination.

Repository README.md Specification Template

The root **`README.md`** serves as the primary technical landing page and must strictly conform to the following structural format:

````
# Project 13: 13-Year All-India Air Quality Trend & 2020 Lockdown Anomaly Quantifier
[![Course](https://img.shields.io/badge/Course-Programming%20in%20Python-blue.svg)](https://duk.ac.in)
[![Python](https://img.shields.io/badge/Python-3.11%2B-brightgreen.svg)](https://python.org)
[![License](https://img.shields.io/badge/License-MIT-yellow.svg)](LICENSE)

## 1. Project Overview & Domain Context
- **Institution:** Digital University Kerala (MTech AI / MSc AI)
- **Course:** M4010104 / M4020104 — Programming in Python | **Instructor:** Dr. Sunil TT
- **Dataset:** Time-Series Air Quality Data of India (2010–2023) on Kaggle (https://www.kaggle.com/datas

## 2. System Architecture & Pipeline Design
[Provide an ASCII or Mermaid architecture flow diagram showing raw ingestion -> validation -> analyzer -

## 3. Installation & Environment Setup
```bash
git clone https://github.com/<your-team>/india-air-quality-lockdown-study.git
cd india-air-quality-lockdown-study
python -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate  # On Windows: venv\Scripts\activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

## 4. Execution Instructions
### A. Running the Standalone Application
```bash
python run_pipeline.py --input data/raw/india_air_quality_13yr_raw.csv --output-dir data/processed --rep
```
### B. Running the Development Notebook
```bash
jupyter notebook notebooks/development_cycle.ipynb
```

## 5. Key Analytical & Statistical Findings (Q1–Q12 Summary)
[Provide a concise markdown summary table detailing raw vs. clean counts, regression coefficients, anoma

## 6. Interactive Telemetry Dashboard
Explore the live interactive Plotly visualization hosted on GitHub Pages:
🔗 [Live Project Dashboard](https://<your-team>.github.io/india-air-quality-lockdown-study/interactive_d
````

```
## 7. Contributor Git Commit & Pull Request Log Table
| Contributor Name | GitHub Handle | Assigned Module / Tasks | Verified Commit Hash Range | Merged Pull
| :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- |
| [Student Full Name] | `@github_handle` | Modular Architecture (`src/ingestion.py`, `src/analyzer.py`,
```

6. Evaluation Rubric & Mandatory Academic Integrity Governance

Projects are evaluated on a 25-mark scale based on code quality, mathematical correctness, visualization depth, git collaboration discipline, and live technical defense:

Assessment Criterion	Basis of Evaluation & Deliverable Verification	Max Marks
1. Data Curation & File I/O Pipeline (Q1–Q2)	Robust line-by-line file reading with defensive **`try-except`** handling, physical/domain bounds validation, clean CSV output, and structured **`lockdown_air_audit.log`** reporting.	**5 Marks**
2. OOP, NumPy & Pandas Analytics (Q3–Q9)	Modular **`LockdownImpactAuditor`** class architecture, vectorized NumPy feature re-derivations (verified via **`np.allclose`**), regression modeling, and Pandas rolling/groupby/melt operations.	**6 Marks**
3. Multi-Library Visualizations (Q10–Q12)	Publication-quality Matplotlib confidence envelope/trend plot, Seaborn correlation heatmap and distribution violin plot, and standalone interactive Plotly HTML dashboard.	**5 Marks**
4. Software Packaging, GitHub & Documentation	Clean directory layout, comprehensive **`README.md`**, working GitHub Pages site, **`development_cycle.ipynb`** notebook, standalone **`run_pipeline.py`**, and balanced individual Git commits/PRs.	**4 Marks**
5. Live Presentation & Code Viva-Voce Defense	Technical walkthrough and individual live viva defense where each student must explain or modify lines of code in real time without external assistance.	**5 Marks**

STRICT ACADEMIC INTEGRITY & ZERO-TOLERANCE AI POLICY (0 MARKS PENALTY): All submitted Python source code (**`.py`**, **`.ipynb`**) and written documentation will be screened through an automated **AI-Code & Plagiarism Detection Suite**. If AI-generated code or synthetic documentation is detected at any checkpoint or final submission, **0 Marks will be awarded immediately** for the entire project. Each student must prove authentic individual code ownership during the live viva-voce examination — *Course Instructor: Dr. Sunil TT*.

7. Milestone Schedule, Submission Checklist & Viva Defense Prompts

To ensure systematic progress across the semester, teams must adhere to three project checkpoints and prepare for on-the-spot live code modification challenges during the viva-voce examination:

Milestone Stage	Scheduled Window	Required Deliverables & Verification Milestones
Checkpoint 1 (Data Ingestion)	Week 11 Lab Session	Repository initialized with contributors and GitHub Pages active. **`src/ingestion.py`** operational with line-by-line filtering, **`clean_india_air_13yr.csv`** exported, and **`lockdown_air_audit.log`** generated.
Checkpoint 2 (Analytics & OOP)	Week 13 Lab Session	**`src/analyzer.py`** complete with **`LockdownImpactAuditor`** class, NumPy feature checks (Q4), outlier masks (Q5), regression modeling (Q6), and exploratory notebook sections.
Final Submission & Viva	Week 15 Project Review	Full package operational: standalone **`run_pipeline.py`**, polished **`development_cycle.ipynb`**, interactive **`interactive_dashboard.html`** on GitHub Pages, 3–4 page PDF report, and live code defense.

Representative Live Viva-Voce Code Modification Challenge

During the individual code viva-voce, the instructor will ask students to execute an immediate 2-minute code modification on their working repository to demonstrate genuine authorship:

- **Challenge Prompt:** *"In src/analyzer.py, shift the lockdown comparison window from April-May 2020 to March-June 2020. Re-run your module and report the revised percentage drop in NO2 for top industrial centers."*